

Sofia's Solo Playbook

Stay a Little Longer · Lyrical · Choreography by Hannah · Rehearsals with Ms. Brittany · Winter Formal Sat Jan 9, 2027

105
days to
Winter
Formal

My music map (track is 2:04)

SOFT 0:00-0:48 · the "feel it" half

FULL 0:48-1:52 · the tricks half

fade

The big beat lands about every 2.3 seconds in the loud half. Finish every shape **on** the beat, not a hair after. The music is fully gone at **2:00**: hold the last shape until then.

Where the big moments land

~0:12	Floor work + tailbone balance
~0:18	Lunge reach (arms past the body)
~0:34	Attitude, arms up
0:48	Music swells
~0:50	Cartwheel — right on the swell
~1:08	Walkover / handstand line
~1:42	Floor kick
~1:50	Passé turns
1:53-2:00	Floor ending — hold it

My superpowers (already strong!)

- Smooth floor work: no crashing in or out
- Big full-body reach on the lunge
- Brave acro: cartwheel, walkover, clean handstand line
- Straight standing leg in attitude and passé

My fixes (the picture judges see)

- ☐ **Point + straighten.** Every floor extension: knee straight, foot pointed. Tailbone balance too.
- ☐ **Side leg: pick one.** Clean attitude or straight. Never halfway.
- ☐ **Eyes up.** No mirror, no Hannah. Every section has a spot to look at.
- ☐ **Long arms.** Elbows straight overhead, shoulders down.
- ☐ **Passé high.** Toe to the side of the knee, up on relevé, sharp spot.
- ☐ **Trick prep is dancing.** Don't drop your head early before the cartwheel.
- ☐ **Donut roll:** chin tucked, roll over the shoulder, chest leads.
- ☐ **Hold the ending** until the music is gone at 2:00.

Where do I look? (fill in with Ms. Brittany)

Section

My focal point

Opening walk

Floor work

Attitude / standing

Cartwheel → walkover

Floor kick / turns

Ending

Ms. Brittany's top 3 right now

Practice at home

Thu · Fri · Sun at home (30-40 min) · Wed 3:30-4:00 solo rehearsal with Ms. Brittany · Mon & Tue = rest

The routine (check them off)

WARM UP 5 min

☐ Jumping jacks, arm circles, leg swings

STRONG 10 min

☐ Hollow hold + superman 3×20 sec

☐ Plank + side plank 2×20-30 sec

☐ Slow relevés 2×15 · one-leg balance 20 sec each

☐ Lying leg lifts, straight knee, 2×10 each side

BENDY 10 min · after warm-up only

☐ Right, left, middle split + straddle, 20-30 sec each

TECHNIQUE 10 min

☐ Passé balance on relevé 5-10 sec, both sides

☐ 10 single pirouettes each side, spot!

☐ Kicks to hip height: straight knee, pointed foot

☐ Arms overhead in the mirror: long elbows

THE DANCE 5 min

☐ Mark it once, then FULL OUT once, eyes up

☐ Sunday: film it. Watch. Pick ONE fix. Say one thing you loved.

The road to January 9

1 Own it · Sep 28-Oct 25

Whole solo with NO cues by Oct 18. Build strength + bendy base. Mark the trio weekly.

2 Clean it · Oct 26-Nov 29

Pointed feet, straight knees, long arms, high passé. Trick preps look like dancing. Light week at Thanksgiving.

3 Perform it · Nov 30-Jan 3

Eyes up with focal points. Two full-out runs back to back on Sundays. Costume on twice in December. Hold the ending to 2:00.

4 Taper · Jan 4-9

One run a day, no new skills, no deep stretching. Mini show for family Thu Jan 7. Early bedtime.

After the Formal: Press Play (classes only, Jan 15-17) → Hollywood Connection Jan 22-24 → Ryze Feb 19-21 → ID Feb 26-28 → Hollywood Vibe Apr 30-May 2.

Say it before every run

Point. Straighten. Eyes up.

Long arms. Hit the beat. Hold the end.

Rules that keep me dancing

- Warm up before stretching. A stretch feels like a stretch, never pain.
- No oversplits. No bridges unless Hannah says yes.
- Acro at home only on the mat or with a spotter.
- If it hurts, stop. Sleep and water are part of training.

Practice tracker · color a box for every session

Week of	Thu	Fri	Sun	Filmed?	This week's one fix
Sep 28					
Oct 5					
Oct 12					
Oct 19 · no cues!					
Oct 26					
Nov 2					
Nov 9					
Nov 16					
Nov 23 · light					
Nov 30					
Dec 7					
Dec 14 · costume					
Dec 21					
Dec 28					
Jan 4 · taper					SHOW SAT JAN 9

My tricks: how to make each one better

One trick per Friday. Rotate through all eight, then start again. Warm up first, every time.

1 • Tailbone balance (~0:12)

Goal: knee locked, foot pointed, chest up.

- ☐ Sit, extend one leg, point the foot, hold 5 sec. 5 each leg.
- ☐ Boat pose (both legs up, straight) 3×15 sec.
- ☐ Cue: **lock the knee before the foot leaves the floor.**

2 • Side extension / attitude (~0:34)

Goal: one clear shape, never halfway. Ask Ms. Brittany: attitude or straight?

- ☐ At a counter: développé side, 4 counts up, hold 2, 4 counts down. 6 each side.
- ☐ Side-lying leg lifts, pointed foot, 2×12 each side.
- ☐ Standing leg: heel presses **down**, knee straight, hip stays square.

3 • Cartwheel on the swell (~0:50)

Goal: it looks like dancing, not a setup, and it lands on the beat.

- ☐ Drill the 4 counts **before** it: reach, look, place. Head stays up until hands go down.
- ☐ Cartwheel over a tape line on the floor: legs pass straight through vertical.
- ☐ Land + arm finish exactly on the beat. Play the track from 0:44 and repeat 5×.

4 • Walkover / handstand line (~1:08)

Goal: straight legs through vertical, split shape at the top, quiet landing.

- ☐ Wrist circles first. Belly-to-wall handstand 3×10–15 sec.
- ☐ Kick up to vertical with straight legs, 5×. Then open to a split at the top, 5×.
- ☐ Kick-overs **only** on the mat with a spotter until cleared in class.

5 • Floor kick (~1:42)

Goal: height from the hip, not the back; pointed foot at the top.

- ☐ 8 slow kicks each side, 4 counts up, 4 down. Point at the top.
- ☐ Cue: **kick from the hip, keep the back long.**
- ☐ Hamstring stretch after (not before) the kicks.

6 • Passé turns (~1:50)

Goal: toe to the side of the knee, high relevé, sharp spot, arms round.

- ☐ Passé balance on relevé, 10 sec, both sides. Wobble = try again, not step down.
- ☐ Quarter turns ×8, half turns ×8, then singles ×10 each side.
- ☐ Put a sticker on the wall and spot it. Arms hug a big beach ball.

7 • The ending (1:53–2:00)

Goal: the shape holds, breathing but still, until the music is completely gone.

- ☐ Play the last 15 seconds of the real track 5×. Hold. Count 8 more after you think it's over.
- ☐ Face stays in the story. No looking up, no smile-and-relax until the music is gone.

8 • Donut roll (~0:19–0:25)

Goal: a round, open shape that rolls over the shoulder, never the head.

- ☐ Warm the back: cobra, then seal stretch, 20 sec each.
- ☐ Kneeling backbend, hands to heels, 3×5 sec. Bridge holds 3×10 sec.
- ☐ Donut shape: knees bent, chest open, eyes to the ceiling, then the wall behind.
- ☐ Roll: **chin tucked, over the shoulder.** Cue: chest leads, eyes follow.

How to practice a trick

- **Slow first.** Do it at half speed 3× before full speed.
- **Film one.** Watch it. Compare with the picture in your head.
- **Fix one thing.** Not three. One.
- **Then put it back in the dance** with the counts before and after it.
- **Stop before tired.** Tired tricks teach bad habits.